

person to buddy up with. Often, it's easier for someone who's not too close to you to hold you accountable, and vice versa – plus, it can be easier to be open about your challenges and mistakes with a relative stranger than with someone who knows you inside out. It's up to you to figure out what will suit you best.

Whoever your accountability buddy might be, the first thing that you'll need to do is have an initial chat to share your goals and the habits you'd like to form (and break) with one another. You will each take note of your own goals, and the other person's, and then set regular catch-ups to ensure that you're each staying on track. A good accountability buddy should be:

- Firm, but fair
- Not enabling of destructive behaviour
- Able to listen and discuss slip-ups without judgement
- Help you to work through hurdles and stumbling blocks
- Trustworthy and discreet
- Reliable
- Not in direct competition with you

This list will give you an idea of what to look for in your partner, but it also lets you know how to be a good partner in return, because this is a symbiotic relationship. You can either have a time-limited partnership that centres around